Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Tuesday, April 19, 2022

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Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Councillors	M. Crawford S. Lee R. Tyler Morin A. Khan L. Bower
Regrets:		J. Dies

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:02 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on March 28, 2022 be adopted.
CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, noted that no questions had been received regarding the contents of the meeting agenda.

5. Delegations and Presentations

5.1 Delegation & Proclamation: The Annual Commemoration and Formal Recognition of the Armenian Genocide of 1915

George Kharlakian, O.C.T., Resident of Ajax, delivered a presentation regarding the Armenian Genocide of 1915. G. Kharlakian discussed community engagement and religious equity in Ajax, Armenian Genocide education and awareness, historical facts, the Armenian population in the Greater Toronto Area (GTA), recognition of Armenian Heritage month, impacts on socio economic status and familial ties, and genocide prevention.

Mayor Collier presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed April 24, 2022 as Armenian Genocide Memorial Day in the Town of Ajax.

5.2 Delegation: Definition of “Excessive” Barking or Howling in By-law Number 48-2017 (Dog and Cat By-law)

Rodney Doody, Ajax Resident, expressed concerns with the definition of ‘excessive’ barking or howling in By-law number 48-2017 (Dog and Cat By-law) and urged Council to consider the inadequacy of the definition ‘excessive’. R. Doody discussed quantification,

noting that the by-law does not account for barking that persists throughout the day nor does it stipulate how the cumulative 20 minutes are to be calculated.

Council Members asked how other municipalities quantify 'excessive' barking. R. Doody responded to the question from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked R. Doody for the presentation.

5.3 Delegation & Proclamation: Youth Week 2022

Ashley Adams, Acting Community Recreation Supervisor – Youth Development, provided an overview of the Youth Engagement Advisory Committee's (YEAC) mandate and explained the purpose of Youth Week in Ajax. A. Adams introduced Alexandra King, Youth Ambassador, who reviewed activities conducted by the YEAC throughout the year and events occurring during Youth Week, including the upcoming Encourage Me Ajax Youth Symposium event on May 4th. A. King acknowledged Ajax's twenty Youth Ambassadors for 2022 and requested that Council proclaim May 1-7 as Youth Week in the Town of Ajax.

Council Members asked questions regarding top priorities for youth in Ajax and event details for the art workshop. A. King responded to questions from Council Members.

Mayor Collier presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed May 1-7, 2022 as Youth Week in the Town of Ajax.

5.4 Presentation: Status Update Presenting the New Grandview Kids Facility in Ajax – Here we GROW!

Lorraine Sunstrum-Mann, CEO, Grandview Children's Centre, provided an update on the new Grandview Kids facility in Ajax. L. Sunstrum-Mann discussed corporate partners, project design, project vision, and design inspiration and themes. L. Sunstrum-Mann played a short video highlighting design elements, intuitive wayfinding elements, activities and facilities, family resources, the Campbell Children's School, safety, security and accessibility features, outdoor amenities, and landscape design.

Council Members asked questions regarding employment projections, future plans for the Oshawa facility, project timelines, opportunities to access amenities during the winter months, and the new Grandview Kids ground-breaking event at the new headquarters in Ajax. L. Sunstrum-Mann responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked L. Sunstrum-Mann for the presentation.

With the consent of Members present, item 5.6 was advanced in the order business.

5.6 Presentation: Durham Regional Police Service (DRPS) – Human Trafficking

Detective Constable Rebecca Richardson, Durham Regional Police Human Trafficking Unit, provided an overview of the human trafficking unit including unit size, noting that the unit has adopted a victim-centred approach and has partnered with a human trafficking crisis intervention counsellor to offer support to victims. Karly Church, Human Trafficking Crisis Intervention Counsellor, Victim Services of Durham Region, noted that Durham Region is a hub for human trafficking due to its proximity to the 401 corridor. K. Church discussed collaborative efforts with DRPS, engagement with community partners, success of the victim-centred model, and average age of victims. Detective Constable Richardson reviewed 2021 statistics.

Council Members asked questions regarding age of the youngest trafficking victim, program success metrics, supports and services available for victims, conviction rates, and signs of human trafficking. K. Church and Detective Constable Richardson, responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked Detective Constable Richardson and K. Church for their presentation.

5.5 Presentation: Durham Regional Police Service (DRPS) – Community Safety Plan

Staff Sergeant Shaun Carter and Sergeant Jason Fisher, DRPS of Durham Regional Police West Division, delivered a presentation regarding the 2022 West Division Community Safety Plan. Staff Sergeant Carter and Sergeant Fisher discussed improvements to roadway safety, property crime reduction strategies, violent crime

reduction strategies, community engagement and innovation in service delivery, enhanced communication strategies, and social development initiatives.

Council Members asked questions regarding status of availability of standardized reports related to trends and traffic enforcement, dangerous intersections in Ajax, community safety campaigns, and if there is evidence of spillover effect of red light cameras. Staff Sergeant Carter and Sergeant Fisher, responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked Staff Sergeant Carter and Sergeant Fisher for the presentation.

5.7 **Presentation: HMS Ajax & River Plate Veterans Association Visit**

Poonam Swift, Corporate & Community Festivals & Events Coordinator and Jennifer Larmand, Administrative Assistant to the Mayor, delivered a presentation regarding plans for the HMS Ajax & River Plate Veterans Associate Visit. J. Larmand and P. Swift discussed visitation dates and number of visitors, Mayor and Council hosted events, street dedications, farewell activities including a tree planting ceremony and dedication at the Indigenous Community & Healing Garden, followed by a parade, ceremony and reception at the Royal Canadian Legion.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked P. Swift and J. Larmand for the presentation.

6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence item 6.8 for discussion.

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the balance of the report (Items 6.1, 6.2, 6.3, 6.4, 6.5, 6.6 and 6.7) dated April 19, 2022 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Item 6.8

Council Members expressed support for the road safety initiative.

Council Members asked questions regarding exemptions to the Town's sign by-law, costs to procure speed boards, and program timeframes. Derek Hannan, Manager of By-law Services and Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That Item 6.8 (Randy Ireland, Chair, Ajax Pickering Road Watch – Ajax Pickering Road Watch – Letter to Council) of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1. **Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report**

7.2.1 **Community Affairs & Planning Committee, April 4, 2022**

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated April 4, 2022, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.2. **General Government Committee Report**

7.2.2 **General Government Committee, April 11, 2022**

Moved by: A. Khan

Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the General Government Committee Report dated April 11, 2022, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated April 19, 2022, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 Departmental Reports

None

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Council Members discussed a Region of Durham motion regarding modified vehicles in Durham Region highlighting proposed amendments to the Highway Traffic Act, the implementation of a clear garbage bag pilot program in the Municipality of Clarington, survey results for design options for bus shelters along the Kingston Road corridor (Highway 2), a new Regional E-scooter By-law, Vision Zero speed camera statistics, a pilot project called "Leading Pedestrian Interval Locations", and growth management scenario recommendations.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of April 19, 2022 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 Ending Unfair Rent Increases for New Builds

Regional Councillor Crawford and Councillor Tyler Morin introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

WHEREAS there have been dramatic price increases in Ontario's rental housing market with bidding wars becoming normal practice due to a shortage of rental houses and hot housing prices, and without rent increase limits many Ajax residents will be at risk of being priced out of their homes;

AND WHEREAS Ontario's Residential Tenancies Act, 2006, imposes yearly guidelines on rent increases based on the Ontario Consumer Price Index, however rental units being occupied for the first time after November 15, 2018 are exempt from these guidelines. There is no limit to how much a landlord can increase the rent each year for these units;

AND WHEREAS approximately 13.75% of Ajax households are renters, according to Statistics Canada's 2016 census data, and average rents have increased 4.3% in two-bedroom units and 12.9% in 3-bedroom units between 2018 and 2021, according to the Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation;

AND WHEREAS Ajax is in the process of developing a Housing Strategy to further identify housing and affordable needs and propose recommendations to support our community;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council requests the Province of Ontario to eliminate the rules exempting rental units occupied for the first time after November 15, 2018 from annual rent increase guidelines; and

2. This motion be circulated to the Ajax Provincial Constituency Office, the Regional Municipality of Durham, lower-tier municipalities in Durham Region, and the Ontario Big City Mayors.

CARRIED

9.2 **Reducing Emissions by Developing a Green Fleet Strategy**

Regional Councillor Lee and Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents. Council Members asked questions regarding the intent of the motion, and whether the motion would examine cost benefits. Regional Councillor Lee responded to the question from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

WHEREAS the Town of Ajax continues to lead in environmental policy and accompanying actions and recognizes the opportunity to contribute further to greenhouse gas (GHG) emission reduction, save the Town money, and showcase the Town's commitment to sustainability through the development of a green fleet strategy;

AND WHEREAS Ajax Council has declared a climate emergency and in April 2021 passed a motion to set corporate GHG reduction targets to include 40% GHG emissions reduction by 2030, below 2019 levels, and 100% GHG emissions reduction by 2050, below 2019 levels;

AND WHEREAS the Town of Ajax's corporate fleet, including vehicles and equipment, accounts for 36% of the Town's total GHG emissions. This is the second-highest source of corporate emissions after facilities, which account for 46% emissions;

AND WHEREAS Ajax has been proactively improving energy efficiency by implementing energy reduction and conservation projects in the corporate fleet through the Green Fleet Initiative and installation of EV charging infrastructure at Town facilities;

AND WHEREAS electrifying the corporate fleet will implement key action items identified in Ajax's Corporate Energy Conservation and Demand Management Plan and the Integrated Community Sustainability Plan;

AND WHEREAS numerous Canadian municipalities, including Toronto, Montreal, and Richmond, BC, have begun exploring their own sustainable fleet policies, strategies and actions;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. That Ajax Council direct Operations & Environmental Services staff to embark on the development of a green fleet strategy in the next 1-2 years; and that the return on investment of such a program be examined as part of this exercise.

2. This motion be circulated to the Clean Air Partnership, Durham Region Roundtable on Climate Change Committee, and all Durham area municipalities.

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law numbers 28-2022 to 30-2022 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

Regional Councillor Lee noted that he and Mayor Collier will be bringing forward a motion to the May meeting of Council regarding the implementation of an E-scooter by-law to

facilitate an E-scooter program.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members asked if the Town submitted comments regarding *Bill 109: More Homes for Everyone Act, 2022.* G. Romanowski responded to the question from Council Members.

Council Members noted that the new crosswalk at Harwood Avenue and Haskell Avenue is close to completion. Council Members asked when the lights will be installed at the crosswalk. G. Romanowski responded to the question from Council Members.

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities including the unveiling of a new bike rack at Regional Headquarters on April 20, 2022, the Armenian flag raising at Heritage Square on May 2, 2022, Jewish Heritage Month in May, a Holocaust Education Event in May, Iftar at the Masjid Quba on April 20, 2022, and the Town's Spring clean-up event.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk for his service to the Town of Ajax and wished him luck in his future endeavors.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law number 31-2022 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on April 19, 2022 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the April 19, 2022 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (9:27 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

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D-Clerk